

2/6:

Andy Crossen – Product Feedback & Discussion Summary

Goal of the call: Validate problem framing, pressure-test differentiation, and identify early risks of our product with Andy.

1. Problem Framing: What Are We Really Solving?

Key pushback: Andy challenged whether we are solving an automation problem or a decision-quality problem.

He encouraged us to be explicit about time saved vs. mistakes avoided:

- Is the value “faster content” or “safer content”?
- If time-to-approve is already low, what’s the real bottleneck?

Action: Tighten our problem statement to emphasize decision confidence and brand consistency, not just speed or automation.

2. Competitive & Adjacent Landscape (Referenced Examples)

Andy implicitly mapped us against several adjacent categories:

- Meta Ads / Google Business / Yelp
- Limited hyperlocal nuance
- Optimized for ads, not content authenticity
- Scraping / data enrichment tools (e.g., Data365, Hyperscaler-type services)
- Paid data access exists, but doesn’t solve brand fit or creative judgment
- Creator marketplaces / AI negotiation tools (e.g., Tano.ai, CreatorIQ-style enterprise SaaS)
- Focus on negotiation, reach, or influencer workflows

Takeaway: We sit in an awkward but interesting middle: Not ads. Not influencer SaaS. Not pure data tooling. *We should lean into being opinionated about what we exclude.*

3. Matching, Scores, and “Misleading Precision”

Feedback on “match score”.

Andy flagged that a single “match score” risks feeling overconfident, misleading, and hard to justify if outcomes don’t map cleanly

He suggested reframing away from an abstract score, towards explainable signals or facts, such as:

- Past outcomes
- Content attributes
- Observable alignment markers

Related question he raised:

If a creator posts but the business sees no lift, how do we attribute success or failure?

What does “good” look like if foot traffic data is unavailable?

Action: Revisit whether we:

- Keep “match score”
- Replace it with surfaced evidence, rationale, or side-by-side comparisons
- Avoid pretending attribution is cleaner than it is

4. Creator Identity, Trust, and Review Mechanics

Key discussion points:

- Hiding creator identity upfront is directionally interesting, but:
- Trust still has to be earned somewhere
- Operators may want some signal of legitimacy
- Open questions raised:
- Badge vs. individual creators
- Review content vs. review creators
- When and how trust signals are revealed

Underlying theme: *Trust should come from process and proof, not follower count.*

5. Monetization & Incentive Alignment

Pricing model discussion:

Flat platform fee may not be universally preferred. Operators may want flexibility in compensation structures:

- Flat fee
- Commission
- Discounts
- Coupon codes
- Free product / food
- Bonuses tied to usage

Important note: Different incentives may work for different operator maturity levels.

Action: Avoid locking into a single monetization assumption too early. Design the system to support multiple compensation primitives, even if we start with one.

6. Distribution, Visibility, and “Who Got My Brief?”

Andy raised questions around transparency and control:

- How does a creator know:
 - Why they received a brief? (what stood out to the brand about them)
 - How do they compare to others? (evaluation criteria)
- How does an operator know:
 - Who saw the brief?
 - Why were certain businesses preferred?

This mirrors *LinkedIn-style visibility mechanics*. Partial transparency builds trust and total opacity creates suspicion.

Action: Consider lightweight visibility features:

- Match alerts (email / push)
- Clear rationale for why a match happened
- Signals for both sides, not just operators

7. Safety, Security, and Platform Risk

Brief but important callout:

- Safety and security concerns will surface early, even for small platforms
- Especially around:
 - Brand misuse
 - Unauthorized posting
 - Content rights
 - Abuse of briefs or incentives

Action: Explicitly account for safety and misuse scenarios in future iterations, even if MVP handling is manual.

8. High-Level Takeaways

What Andy validated:

- The problem space 
- Hyperlocal nuance is under-served 
- Operator decision fatigue 

His call-outs:

- Be honest about attribution limits
- Don't oversimplify trust
- Clarify whether we optimize for speed, confidence, or risk reduction

Suggested Next Internal Discussion Topics

1. Rewrite the problem statement with "decision confidence" at the center
2. Decide whether "match score" survives, and in what form
3. Define trust signals that do not rely on creator popularity
4. Identify one monetization model to start, without overcommitting
5. Map basic safety and misuse cases before building further